

A DATA INVESTIGATION

Is SlashFilm really obsessed with Gilligan's Island?

A curiosity-driven audit of 68,000+ SlashFilm stories, built to test a simple question: did a 1960s sitcom genuinely become a recurring modern coverage subject, or did it merely become memorable enough to create a frequency illusion?

0.93% of all 21,932 focal-period stories. The spike is real, recent, and measurable.

Prepared from SlashFilm article metadata and headline-level subject classification. August 2026 data is year-to-date.

204
Gilligan-related stories
from 2024 through Aug.
2, 2026

OBSERVED PATTERN
2024-2026

Pattern or frequency illusion?

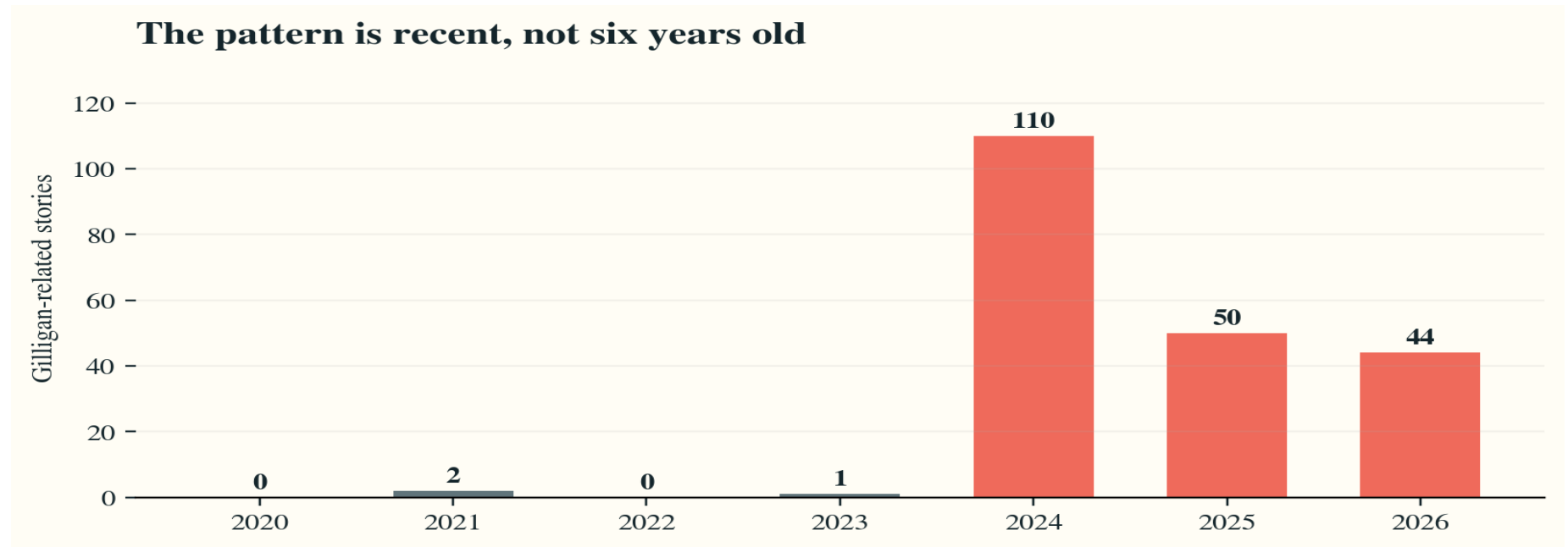
The premise is not that SlashFilm should cover one show instead of another. It is a narrower question: does Gilligan's Island appear often enough in the site's output to qualify as an unusual editorial pattern?

Two measurements keep the test fair. Direct Gilligan's Island means stories centered on the show. Expanded Gilligan universe includes those stories plus articles centered on the seven principal cast members. The expanded count answers the original observation; the direct count prevents cast coverage from being hidden inside a single show label.

The report treats 2024-2026 as the comparison window because those years have the most complete headline-based subject normalization. 2020-2023 appears only as historical context for the Gilligan trend.

Headline classification is intentionally transparent: the title and URL determine the primary subject; ambiguous rows use an auditable headline fallback. Exact aliases, not broad subject buckets, drive the selected-franchise comparisons.

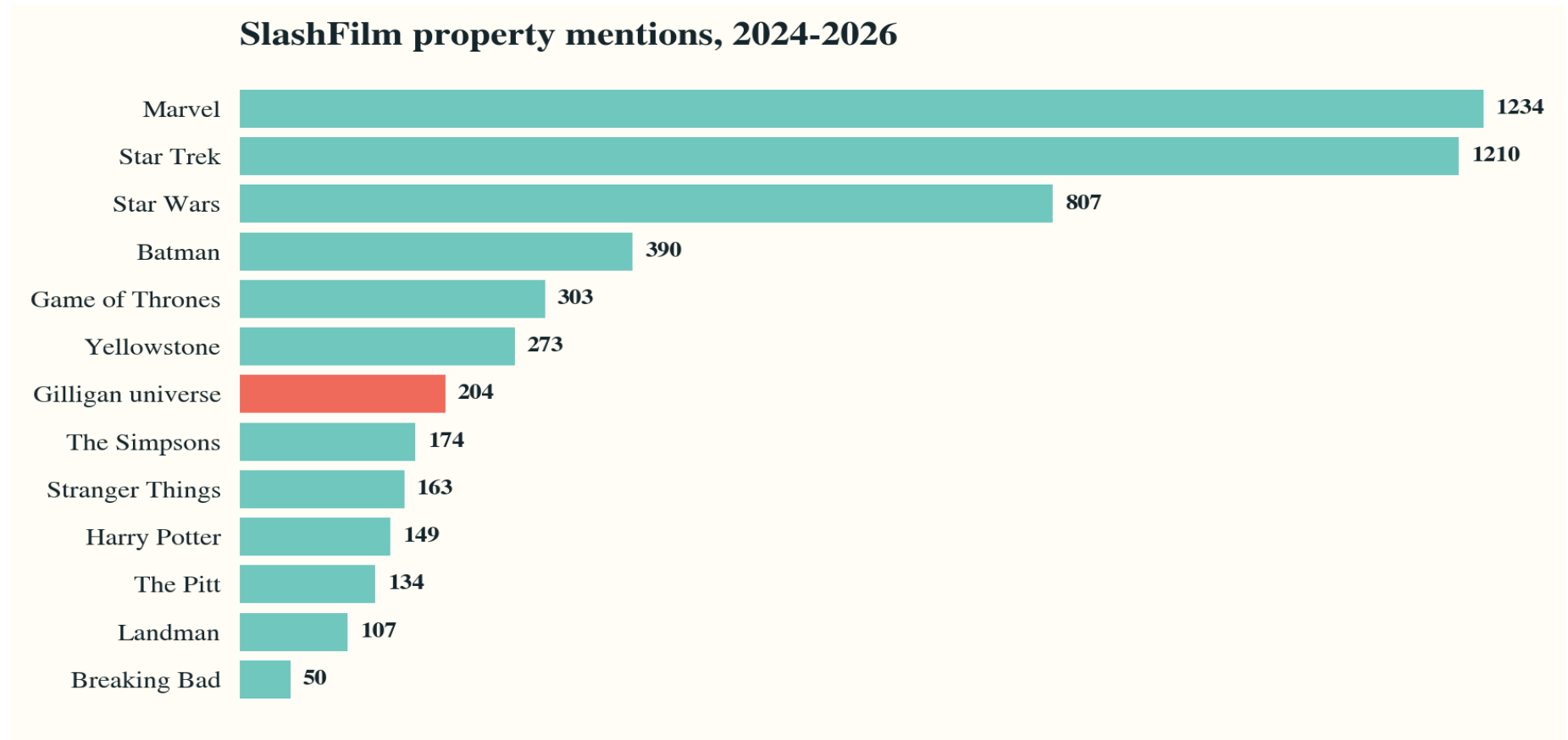
The Gilligan spike is recent



The six-year time series does not support a steady, background level of Gilligan coverage. It instead shows a sharp emergence in 2024, followed by sustained coverage in 2025 and 2026 year-to-date.

The raw annual counts are: 0 (2020), 2 (2021), 0 (2022), 1 (2023), 110 (2024), 50 (2025), and 44 through Aug. 2, 2026.

Gilligan is not Marvel. That is not the point.



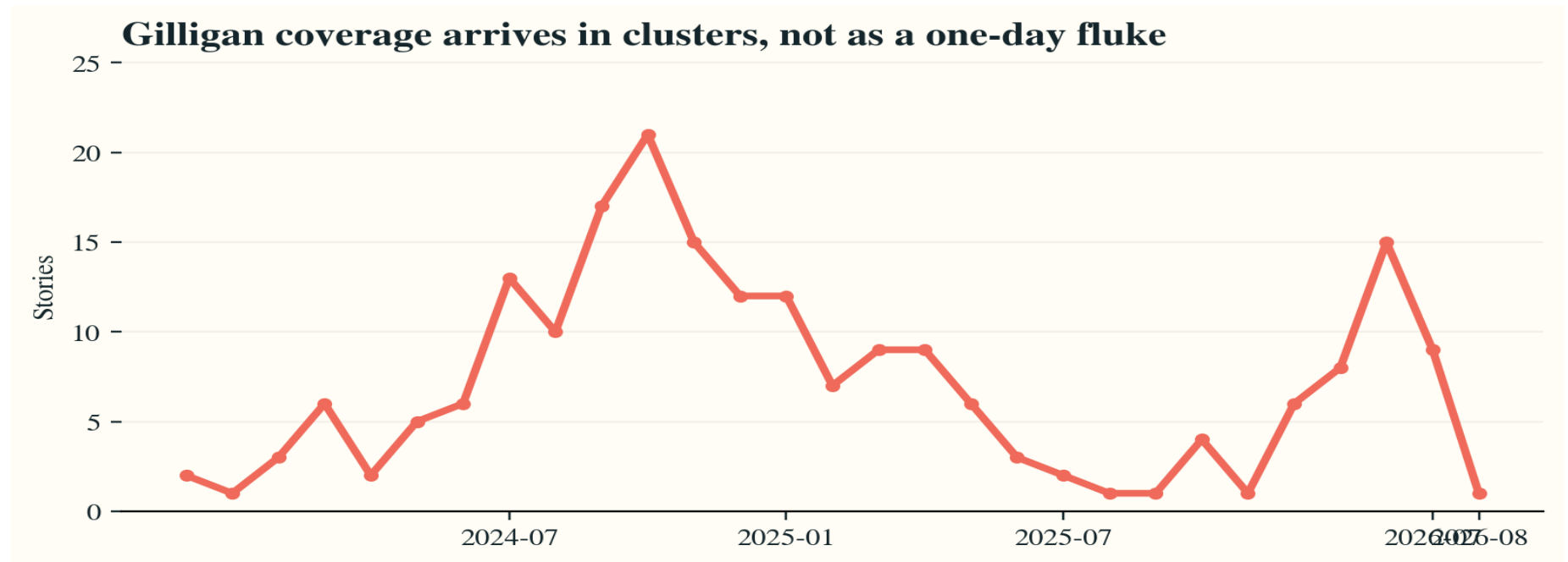
Broad ecosystems such as Marvel, Star Trek, and Star Wars naturally dominate SlashFilm's output. The useful comparison is with individual shows and franchises. In that company, the expanded Gilligan universe is not a trivial tail event.

The island alone, and the island plus its orbit

Metric	2024	2025	2026 YTD	Focal total
Direct Gilligan's Island	66	28	11	105
Expanded Gilligan universe	110	50	44	204

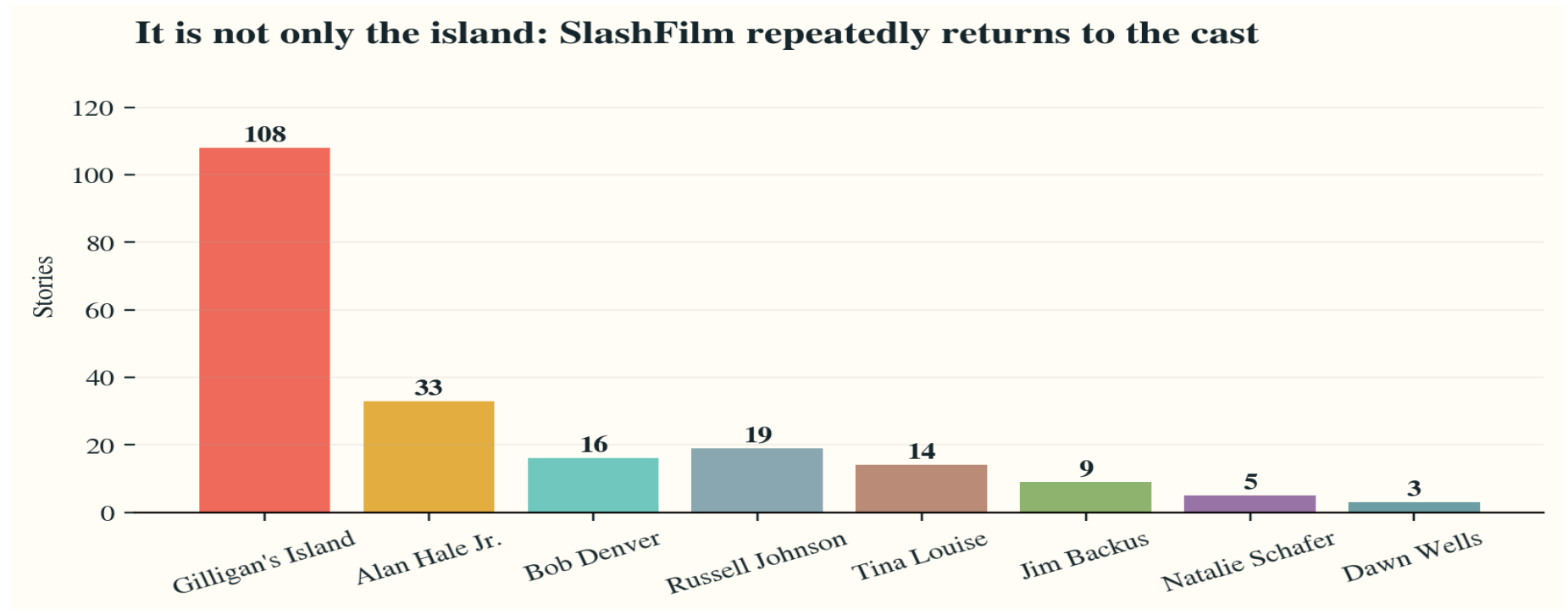
The difference between these lines is the story. In 2026, Alan Hale Jr. becomes the largest single Gilligan-related subject, even when the article is about The Love Boat, a Western, or a forgotten movie role. That is why the expanded measure belongs in the report - but it is displayed separately from direct show coverage.

This is recurring coverage, not one nostalgia package



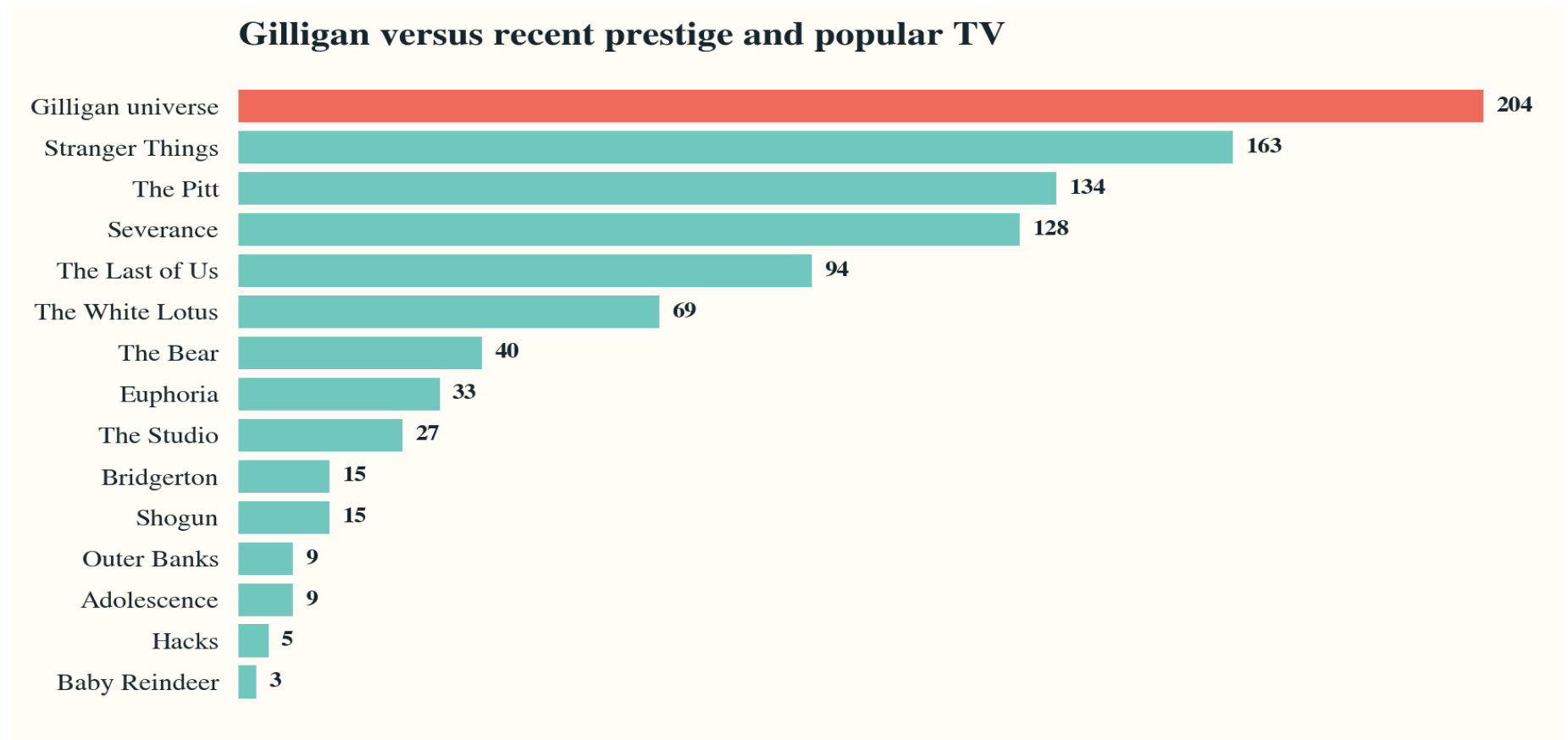
The monthly series shows repeated coverage across many months rather than a single anniversary or reboot event. The 2024 surge is particularly concentrated from July through December; 2026 reaches 15 stories in June alone.

Gilligan is a show, but the cast is the engine



The direct-show label is the biggest single bucket, but cast-member articles turn the property into a much wider content reservoir. The report keeps those two forms of coverage visible rather than treating them as interchangeable.

Where are the big current shows?



This chart compares Gilligan with a deliberately mixed group of award-recognized and culturally visible recent TV. It is not a measure of popularity; it measures SlashFilm article frequency. That distinction matters: coverage volume reflects editorial and search strategy, not audience quality or cultural worth.

The control group includes 2024 Emmy winners such as Shogun, Hacks, and Baby Reindeer, plus 2025 winners The Pitt, The Studio, and Adolescence. Popular-series controls include Euphoria, Outer Banks, Bridgerton, The Last of Us, Stranger Things, The White Lotus, Severance, and The Bear.

So: did you notice a real pattern?

Yes, with an asterisk. The data does not show that Gilligan's Island is one of SlashFilm's largest overall content ecosystems. It does show that Gilligan-related coverage became a surprisingly persistent legacy-TV pattern after 2023, large enough to be visible beside contemporary and award-winning television properties.

The frequency-illusion explanation is not enough on its own. A memorable topic can stand out, but it cannot create 110 Gilligan-related stories in a single year. The better interpretation is that a real coverage pattern exists, and its unusualness comes from the age and apparent cultural distance of the property rather than from it defeating every modern franchise.

This packet does not attempt to explain why SlashFilm publishes these stories or infer traffic performance. It documents frequency, timing, and comparability - no more, no less.

How to read the evidence

Source: SlashFilm article pages indexed through the site's XML sitemaps and collected into year-specific CSVs. The catalog includes title, publication time, URL, primary subject, and Gilligan-related flag. The analysis includes 68,398 total articles from 2020 through Aug. 2, 2026.

Selected-property counts use transparent title/URL aliases. This avoids treating platform names such as HBO, Netflix, or streaming as subjects. It also means the comparison is reproducible, but not a claim that every possible mention in body text has been counted.

External context references: Television Academy, 2024 and 2025 Emmy Awards nominees and winners; Nielsen annual streaming rankings/ARTEY awards. These sources select the current-TV control group; the coverage counts themselves come from SlashFilm.

Limitations: 2020-2023 have less complete subject normalization, so they are used only for the historical Gilligan trend. 2026 is a partial year. Article frequency measures editorial output, not clicks, cultural importance, or audience size.

The data has spoken. It brought a coconut radio.